5. Copper is also needed for bone formation as well as for the maintenance of myelin within the nervous system.

6. Copper helps to form insoluble elastin fibres by cross-linking soluble pro-elastin.

Sources



Figure 9.13 Sources of Copper

Copper is present in many foods and the best sources are meat, nuts, legumes and cereals.

Absorption and excretion:

Absorption of copper into the blood stream occurs via the villi of the small intestine. About 30 percent of the dietary copper is absorbed in the duodenum.Only 10 - 60 µg of copper is excreted in normal urine in 24 hours.

Deficiency

1. A diet deficient in copper causes loss of weight.

2. Copper deficiency produces microcytic hypochromic anemia.

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